AnnMarie Dittell

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ACCESSIBILITY & INCLUSIVE UX LEADER | PROGRAM & PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Accessibility and inclusive UX leader with 13+ years of experience across healthcare, education, and government. Combines WCAG and Section 508 expertise with accessibility strategy, inclusive UX, program leadership, and organizational change. Skilled at aligning product, engineering, design, and business teams, translating technical requirements into scalable practices, and leading initiatives from strategy through validation.

CORE EXPERTISE

Accessibility Strategy & Program Leadership: Program/Project Management | Agile/SAFe | Roadmaps | Governance | Cross-Functional Leadership | Stakeholder Communication | Risk & Process Management | Vendor & Budget Management

Accessibility & Inclusive UX: WCAG 2.2 | Section 508 | ADA | WAI-ARIA | Shift-Left Accessibility | Accessible UX | Design Reviews | Audits | Remediation | VPAT/ACR | PDF/UA

Testing & Technology: NVDA | JAWS | VoiceOver | Keyboard Testing | axe DevTools | ANDI | Adobe Acrobat Pro | Figma | Figma Make

Training & Content Accessibility: Accessibility Training | Coaching | Word | PowerPoint | Excel | PDF Remediation | Accessible Templates | Multimedia Accessibility

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Accessibility Technical Lead | Peraton

August 2026 – Present | End Client: Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services

- Provide Section 508 and WCAG expertise for the ClaimsCore proof-of-concept, identifying and remediating accessibility issues before CMS submission.
- Established accessible templates and review processes that standardize accessibility expectations and reduce downstream remediation.
- Partner with project management, SMEs, communications, and stakeholders to strengthen quality control, deliverable tracking, and accessibility throughout the project lifecycle.

Senior Accessibility Engineer | Softrams, a Tria Federal Company

November 2024 – July 2026 | End Client: Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services

- Led accessibility testing and remediation across six CMS projects, partnering with UX and development teams to improve WCAG conformance, usability, and user experience.
- Identified four major accessibility defects in the CMS Design System and partnered with teams to remediate shared components, improving accessibility for internal projects and other CMS vendors using the same design system.
- Shifted accessibility earlier through Figma design reviews, shared-component evaluations, developer guidance, and AI-assisted prototyping with Figma Make.
- Trained and evaluated the TriaLabs AI Accessibility Agent against WCAG checks, rewriting prompts to reduce false positives and improve the accuracy of bug-severity classification.
- Analyzed accessibility defect trends across projects and created cross-project standards, implementation guidance, and a company-wide internal Accessibility Hub.

Section 508 Specialist | Agility Consultants, LLC

April 2024 – November 2024 | End Client: U.S. Department of Agriculture

- Audited and remediated complex PDF forms and documents, helping increase accessible document compliance from 0% to 78%.
- Redesigned 12 inaccessible legacy forms into accessible versions and provided remediation guidance across three cross-functional teams.
- Delivered document-accessibility training and reviewed web wireframes to help teams identify and prevent accessibility barriers earlier in development.

Accessibility and Compliance Manager | Pearson

January 2018 – March 2024

- Led accessibility strategy and compliance across digital learning products and content, managing roadmaps, cross-functional workstreams, vendors, risks, executive reporting, and a $2.7M STEM accessibility budget.
- Directed a one-year remediation initiative across 200+ higher education learning supplements, coordinating 10 internal teams, two vendors, and Accessibility QA; the resulting workflow became the model for future remediation projects.
- Built and governed an Accessibility Hub for internal teams, core vendors, and university audiences, defining how WCAG was applied across learning applications and content, standardizing remediation practices, and supporting university procurement.
- Led an AI-assisted image-description initiative that generated approximately $1.9M in savings over three years while improving accessibility and scalability.
- Advanced shift-left accessibility through design reviews, training, coaching, and collaboration with technology teams to improve authoring tools and accessible content creation.

Program Specialist | Arizona Department of Education

October 2012 – December 2017

- Supported a department-wide accessibility remediation effort following an Office for Civil Rights complaint, helping bring the website and digital documents back into compliance and successfully close the OCR case.
- Led a two-year website redesign focused on accessibility, responsive design, usability, and improved access to statewide information.
- Delivered department-wide accessibility training to 50+ web developers and 100+ content creators, strengthening accessible web and document practices across the organization.

ADDITIONAL LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Founder & Principal | K–8 Charter School | Stepping Stones Academy

Founded and operated a K–8 charter school, serving as principal for 13 years and leading strategy, staff, budgets, compliance, projects, and stakeholders. Previously taught for 10 years, building expertise in special education, diverse user needs, communication, and inclusive learning.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Professional in Accessibility Core Competencies (CPACC) | IAAP DHS

Trusted Tester | U.S. Department of Homeland Security

SAFe® 6 Agilist | Scaled Agile, Inc.

Certificate, Web Development | Phoenix College

Master’s Degree, Education | Northern Arizona University Bachelor’s

Degree, Special Education | Arizona State University